

Decent Coaching Classes
VIII CBSE
Academic Conquest - IV
Subject: History — Chapter 3: Ruling the Countryside

Time: 1 hour

Marks: 30

Section A — Multiple Choice Questions (1 mark each) (6)

1. Who appointed the East India Company as the Diwan of Bengal?
(a) Robert Clive (b) Shah Alam II (c) Warren Hastings (d) Charles Cornwallis
2. Who introduced the system of auctioning revenue collection rights in Bengal?
(a) Robert Clive (b) Warren Hastings (c) Charles Cornwallis (d) Thomas Munro
3. Under the Permanent Settlement, zamindars became:
(a) Government officials (b) Hereditary landowners (c) Tenants (d) Indigo planters
4. Who introduced the Ryotwari system of land revenue?
(a) Charles Cornwallis (b) Thomas Munro (c) Holt Mackenzie (d) Warren Hastings
5. The Mahalwari system was introduced mainly in:
(a) Madras Presidency (b) Bombay Presidency (c) North-western India (d) Bengal only
6. The Indigo Rebellion of 1859–60 is also known as the:
(a) Champaran Satyagraha (b) Blue Rebellion (c) Revolt of 1857 (d) Quit India Movement

Section B — Very Short Answer Questions (2 marks each) (8)

1. What was the Permanent Settlement of 1793?
2. Name any two cash crops that farmers were forced to grow by the British, and mention where each was grown.
3. Who were 'lathiyals' and 'gomasthas'?
4. Why did the Company's income remain unstable under Reza Khan's system of revenue collection?

Section C — Short Answer Questions (4 marks each) (12)

- 1. Explain the main features and problems of the Permanent Settlement system.**

OR

Explain the Ryotwari system of revenue collection and its drawbacks.

- 2. Describe the two systems — *nij* and *ryoti* — through which indigo was cultivated in India.**

- 3. Explain the causes and course of the Indigo Rebellion of 1859–60.**

OR

Describe Mahatma Gandhi's role in supporting indigo farmers (the Champaran Satyagraha).

Section D — Case-Based Question (4)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow:

Raghunath, a kind zamindar in Nadia district of Bengal, sympathised with the farmers working on his land. The British planters forced the farmers to grow indigo instead of rice, leaving them with very little money and deep into debt. Their families struggled to survive, which made them refuse growing indigo and resist the planters.

One day, a British planter asked Raghunath to evict the farmers who refused to grow indigo. Fearing the loss of his estate, Raghunath obeyed. But he felt guilty of not standing up for the farmers. Soon after, the farmers revolted and attacked the planter's factory. Raghunath secretly helped them in their fight by providing food and shelter, even though he knew it was dangerous.

The rebellion made the British investigate the unfair indigo system. Raghunath's support to the farmers shows the difficult position zamindars faced under British rule.

- (a) Why did farmers in Nadia district refuse to grow indigo? (1)
- (b) How did Raghunath support the farmers during their revolt? (1)
- (c) What does Raghunath's support show about the position of zamindars under British rule? (2)